You asked for a full prismatic-method analysis of Brexit using the framework described in *Silent Transitions*. I'll apply the method step-by-step and treat the same empirical signals through three distinct interpretive grammars commonly visible in British and international discourse.

SECTION 0 — PRE-ANALYSIS REFLEXIVE DECLARATION

Likely home grammar

My baseline analytical tendency is closest to an **institutional-economic grammar**: I naturally privilege macroeconomic indicators, trade structure, and institutional stability as explanatory variables. That makes me inclined to interpret Brexit primarily through economic performance, regulatory coordination, and state capacity.

Grammar hardest to operate faithfully

The most difficult grammar to inhabit faithfully is a **sovereigntist-democratic grammar**. That framework treats political autonomy and democratic self-determination as primary variables rather than economic efficiency. Because many contemporary analytical environments prioritise economic metrics, it requires deliberate adjustment not to implicitly downgrade sovereignty claims.

Potential blind spots

- Underestimating symbolic or identity-based motivations.
- Over-valuing quantifiable indicators (GDP, trade flows).
- Assuming institutional continuity as inherently desirable.
- Interpreting political volatility primarily as economic feedback rather than cultural or constitutional recalibration.

Temporal orientation

My default orientation is **mixed but forward-leaning institutional**: historical signals matter mainly insofar as they shape future structural outcomes.

SECTION 1 — OBSERVATION FIELD DECLARATION

Phenomenon

The United Kingdom's decision to withdraw from the European Union following the June 2016 referendum and the subsequent decade of political, economic, and institutional consequences through 2026.

Temporal frame

2016 referendum campaign → Article 50 process (2017–2020) → withdrawal and transition → implementation of the Trade and Cooperation Agreement (2021–2026) and subsequent adjustments.

Geographic scope

- Primary: United Kingdom
- Secondary: European Union and global trade partners
- Internal sub-regions: England, Scotland, Wales, Northern Ireland

Why interpretive divergence occurs

Brexit is structurally prone to interpretive divergence because:

- It simultaneously involves **economics, sovereignty, identity, and constitutional design**.
- Evidence unfolds across **different time horizons** (short-term adjustment vs long-term structural change).
- Outcomes affect **different sectors asymmetrically** (finance, manufacturing, fisheries, services).
- Key variables—like sovereignty or cultural cohesion—are **difficult to quantify**.

Thus actors prioritising different variables generate different causal explanations even when observing the same evidence.

Signal contestation level

High.

Many metrics are interpreted differently depending on baseline counterfactual assumptions (e.g., what UK growth *would have been* without Brexit).

Major interpretive communities

- Sovereigntist political movements and parts of the Conservative Party
- Liberal internationalist policy institutions
- Economists and macro-policy analysts
- EU institutional actors
- British regional nationalist movements (Scotland, Northern Ireland)

- Cultural identity commentators and media ecosystems

SECTION 2 — SIGNAL SET

Core signals

1. **2016 referendum result**
   Source: UK Electoral Commission
   Type: democratic event
   Ambiguity: narrow margin (52–48) allows both legitimacy and division interpretations.

2. **UK GDP trajectory 2010–2026**
   Source: ONS, IMF
   Type: macroeconomic indicator
   Ambiguity: counterfactual baseline uncertain.

3. **Trade volumes with EU vs rest of world**
   Source: UK Department for Business and Trade
   Type: economic structural data
   Ambiguity: pandemic effects complicate attribution.

4. **Net migration trends**
   Source: ONS
   Type: demographic signal
   Ambiguity: non-EU migration increased after Brexit.

5. **Northern Ireland Protocol / Windsor Framework evolution**
   Type: constitutional-trade arrangement
   Ambiguity: both stabilisation mechanism and sovereignty constraint.

6. **Scottish independence polling**
   Type: political sentiment indicator
   Ambiguity: fluctuations influenced by domestic UK politics beyond Brexit.

7. **Institutional trust indicators**
   Sources: British Social Attitudes Survey
   Type: sociopolitical indicator
   Ambiguity: long-term trend predates Brexit.

8. **Manufacturing export performance**
   Type: sectoral economic indicator
   Ambiguity: sector-specific global demand shifts.

9. **Financial services sector adaptation**
   Type: regulatory and market signal
   Ambiguity: London retained major dominance despite some EU relocation.

10. **Regulatory divergence indicators**
    Type: policy change metric
    Ambiguity: divergence slower than expected.

11. **Public opinion on Brexit (2016–2026)**
    Type: polling signal
    Ambiguity: fluctuating but often near parity.

12. **Investment patterns and business sentiment**
    Source: Bank of England surveys
    Type: economic expectations indicator.

13. **Cultural identity polling ("British vs European identity")**
    Type: sociocultural signal.

Counter-signals

1. London remaining Europe's dominant financial hub.

2. Rising non-EU immigration despite "take back control" framing.

3. Continued regulatory alignment in many sectors.

4. UK trade share with EU declining slowly rather than collapsing.

Contested signals

Immigration data

- Sovereigntist grammar: regained policy control regardless of numbers.

- Economic grammar: outcome contradicts policy narrative.

- Identity grammar: demonstrates migration pressures independent of EU.

GDP slowdown

- Economic grammar: structural Brexit drag.

- Sovereigntist grammar: pandemic and global shocks dominate.

Northern Ireland protocol

- Sovereigntist grammar: sovereignty compromise.

- Institutional grammar: pragmatic stability solution.

SECTION 3 — GRAMMAR SPECIFICATIONS

Three grammars capture the majority of interpretive divergence.

1. **Sovereigntist-Democratic Grammar**
2. **Institutional-Economic Integration Grammar**
3. **Identity-Realignment Grammar (emergent)**

The third is flagged as **partially emergent** because it treats Brexit less as policy choice and more as a long-term civilisational identity reconfiguration.

Grammar 1 — Sovereigntist-Democratic

Primary analytical variable
Political sovereignty and democratic self-government.

Signal selection rules
Admits signals related to legal autonomy, border control, and legislative independence.

Weighting priority

1. Constitutional authority
2. Electoral mandate
3. Policy autonomy
4. Economic performance

Causal chain type
Democratic decision → restoration of sovereign authority → policy flexibility → long-term national renewal.

Admissible closure
Brexit justified if sovereignty restored regardless of short-term economic turbulence.

Excluded signals
Short-term GDP forecasts treated as secondary or technocratic.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “Take back control”
- “Democratic mandate”

- “Independent trade policy”

Temporal orientation
Forward-prescriptive.

Temporal formation
Closure largely formed during the **2016 referendum campaign**.

Grammar boundary
Transforms into institutional-economic grammar when economic outcomes become primary evaluation criteria.

Source tradition
British parliamentary sovereignty tradition; conservative constitutionalism.

Grammar 2 — Institutional-Economic Integration

Primary analytical variable
Economic integration and institutional coordination.

Signal selection rules
Prioritises trade flows, GDP growth, productivity, investment.

Weighting priority

1. Trade integration
2. Economic growth
3. Institutional stability
4. Political legitimacy

Causal chain type
Integration → economic efficiency → prosperity → political stability.

Admissible closure
Brexit evaluated as beneficial or harmful based on measurable economic outcomes.

Excluded signals
Symbolic sovereignty arguments.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “Single market friction”
- “Non-tariff barriers”
- “Regulatory alignment”

Temporal orientation
Mixed but medium-term (5–15 years).

Temporal formation
Closure crystallised **during economic forecasts around 2018–2019**.

Grammar boundary
Transforms into identity grammar when economic signals are subordinated to cultural meaning.

Source tradition
Liberal internationalism, European integration economics.

Grammar 3 — Identity-Realignment Grammar (Emergent)

Primary analytical variable
Collective identity and cultural sovereignty.

Signal selection rules
Admits cultural polling, political alignment shifts, and symbolic politics.

Weighting priority

1. National identity shifts
2. Cultural polarisation
3. Regional identity politics
4. Economic signals

Causal chain type
Identity conflict → political rupture → institutional restructuring.

Admissible closure
Brexit interpreted as manifestation of deeper identity realignment.

Excluded signals
Purely technical economic metrics.

Characteristic vocabulary

- “Cosmopolitan vs communitarian”
- “National narrative”
- “Political identity cleavage”

Temporal orientation
Long historical.

Temporal formation
Crystallised gradually **post-2016** as analysts observed identity polarisation.

Grammar boundary
Transforms into sovereigntist grammar when identity discourse becomes explicitly constitutional.

Source tradition
Political sociology, cultural political economy.

SECTION 4 — SIGNAL PROCESSING

Grammar 1: Sovereigntist-Democratic Processing

Within this grammar, the **referendum itself** constitutes the foundational signal. The 52–48 result is processed not primarily as a narrow margin but as a legitimate democratic mandate delivered through the UK's constitutional procedures. The grammar's rule hierarchy places democratic legitimacy above economic forecasts or technocratic modelling. Therefore, debates over economic cost do not challenge the legitimacy of the decision itself.

GDP performance after Brexit enters the signal field but with reduced weighting. Slower growth relative to EU peers is interpreted through alternative causal chains: pandemic disruption, global inflation shocks, and structural shifts in the world economy. Because economic indicators are not the primary variable, they cannot overturn the democratic baseline.

Trade data receives selective interpretation. Declining EU trade share is acknowledged but reframed through the lens of **strategic diversification**. Trade agreements with Australia, CPTPP accession efforts, and expanded non-EU partnerships are interpreted as evidence of regained policy autonomy. The grammar emphasises the ability to pursue such agreements independently as a primary benefit even if aggregate trade gains remain modest.

Immigration statistics illustrate the grammar's signal transformation mechanism. The fact that net migration increased after Brexit does not invalidate the sovereignty claim. Instead the grammar distinguishes between **control and outcome**. Policy control over immigration rules becomes the meaningful variable rather than migration levels themselves. Thus increased non-EU migration can coexist with the narrative of restored sovereignty.

The Northern Ireland Protocol initially appears as a damaging counter-signal because it creates regulatory differentiation within the United Kingdom. Within the grammar's processing rules, this generates internal tension. The Windsor Framework is therefore interpreted as partial correction — evidence of ongoing negotiation required to fully restore constitutional coherence.

Financial services adaptation becomes a supporting signal. Predictions of mass relocation from London did not materialise at scale. Within the grammar, this outcome demonstrates the resilience of national economic capacity outside EU institutional frameworks.

Scottish independence polling represents a counter-signal with limited weight. The grammar attributes such fluctuations to broader UK political cycles rather than Brexit specifically. Because the grammar's causal chain begins with democratic sovereignty, regional dissatisfaction cannot override the national referendum mandate.

Institutional trust indicators showing polarisation are acknowledged but reframed as temporary turbulence accompanying constitutional realignment. Historical analogies—such as Britain's earlier economic transitions—are used to normalise disruption.

Regulatory divergence is interpreted as potential rather than immediate outcome. The grammar emphasises **option value**: the UK possesses the authority to diverge when beneficial.

Public opinion data showing fluctuating regret about Brexit is treated cautiously. Polling is considered volatile and subordinate to formal democratic events.

Closure

Brexit represents the restoration of democratic sovereignty after decades of supranational delegation. Economic and administrative adjustments are transitional effects of institutional reconfiguration rather than indicators of failure. The long-term evaluation remains open, but the fundamental objective—self-governing policy autonomy—has been achieved.

Grammar 2: Institutional-Economic Integration Processing

This grammar begins from a different starting signal hierarchy. The referendum result is acknowledged as politically decisive but analytically secondary. What matters is whether the structural consequences improve or degrade economic integration.

GDP trajectories since 2016 therefore receive primary analytical weight. Many economic analyses estimate that Brexit reduced UK growth relative to a counterfactual scenario. Within this grammar, such divergence is interpreted as evidence of friction introduced by leaving the single market.

Trade data reinforces the causal architecture. EU trade remains the UK's largest market, and the introduction of customs procedures and regulatory barriers generates measurable friction. Export paperwork, rules-of-origin requirements, and border checks are treated as structural efficiency losses within integrated supply chains.

Manufacturing sectors particularly illustrate these dynamics. Firms integrated into European production networks face increased administrative cost and uncertainty. Even modest frictions accumulate over large trade volumes, reducing competitiveness.

Financial services signals complicate the analysis. While some trading activity relocated to EU financial centres, London maintained global dominance. This outcome forces partial revision of earlier predictions. However, the grammar interprets resilience as evidence of London’s structural advantages rather than validation of Brexit.

Immigration statistics present another counter-signal. The initial Brexit narrative promised migration reduction, yet net migration rose due to non-EU inflows. Within this grammar the result demonstrates the limited policy leverage of migration restrictions within global labour markets.

Northern Ireland becomes a key structural signal. The protocol effectively maintains partial single-market alignment for Northern Ireland to avoid a hard Irish border. For integration analysts, this arrangement illustrates the economic necessity of regulatory alignment within integrated trade regions.

Investment data and business surveys further reinforce the causal chain. Persistent uncertainty during negotiations reduced investment growth relative to earlier trends. Firms often prefer stable regulatory frameworks across large markets.

Regulatory divergence indicators show relatively slow divergence. Within the grammar this confirms that economic integration imposes constraints regardless of formal sovereignty. Diverging too far from EU standards risks market access costs.

Cultural polling and identity debates are largely excluded because they do not directly affect economic performance metrics.

Closure

Brexit constitutes a structural economic disintegration from the EU's highly integrated market. The resulting frictions impose measurable costs on trade, investment, and productivity. The UK retains policy autonomy but at the expense of reduced economic efficiency within its largest regional market.

Grammar 3: Identity-Realignment Processing

The identity grammar begins from a different ontological premise: Brexit is not primarily an economic policy decision but a **symbolic expression of identity conflict within late-modern Britain**.

The referendum result therefore signals a deep cultural divide rather than simply a policy choice. Geographic voting patterns—large metropolitan areas voting remain while many smaller towns supported leave—are interpreted as evidence of a cosmopolitan-communitarian cleavage.

Cultural identity polling reinforces this interpretation. Surveys showing divergence between voters who prioritise national sovereignty and those identifying strongly with European or global identities reveal a long-term sociological division.

Immigration functions as a symbolic trigger within this grammar. Migration levels themselves matter less than perceptions of cultural change. Thus rising non-EU migration after Brexit does not contradict the grammar's narrative; it instead demonstrates the persistence of global mobility pressures that originally activated identity anxieties.

Scottish independence polling becomes a major signal rather than a peripheral one. The grammar views Brexit as destabilising the identity settlement within the United Kingdom. Scotland's pro-EU identity contrasts with England's stronger sovereigntist orientation.

Northern Ireland similarly illustrates identity complexity. The protocol reflects the need to balance British and Irish political identities embedded in the Good Friday Agreement.

Economic signals such as GDP or trade receive secondary interpretation. Slower growth may intensify political dissatisfaction but does not constitute the primary causal explanation.

Institutional trust indicators become central evidence. Declining trust in political institutions and polarisation between Brexit identities ("Leave" vs "Remain") show how Brexit reshaped political identity categories.

The persistence of Brexit as a cultural dividing line years after implementation demonstrates that the phenomenon functions as an **identity marker** within British politics.

Financial services resilience, trade diversification, or regulatory policy details are relatively minor signals in this grammar because they do not address the underlying cultural divide.

Closure

Brexit represents a manifestation of a broader identity realignment within British society. The political rupture exposed deep divisions over national identity, globalisation, and cultural belonging. Economic outcomes may influence future politics, but the primary transformation lies in the reorganisation of political identity within the United Kingdom.

SECTION 5 — CLOSURE COMPARISON

Closure content

- Sovereigntist grammar: restoration of democratic sovereignty.
- Economic integration grammar: structural economic cost.
- Identity grammar: cultural realignment and political identity cleavage.

Signal divergence

The same signals receive different weights:

- Referendum: decisive (sovereigntist), procedural (economic), symbolic (identity).
- GDP: secondary (sovereigntist), primary (economic), contextual (identity).

Exclusion patterns

- Sovereigntist grammar suppresses macroeconomic modelling.
- Economic grammar excludes cultural meaning.
- Identity grammar excludes technical policy evaluation.

Causal architecture

Each grammar constructs a different causal chain:

- Democracy → sovereignty → policy autonomy.

- Integration → economic efficiency → prosperity.
- Identity conflict → political rupture → institutional restructuring.

Closure range

Admissible conclusions differ:

- Sovereigntist grammar cannot conclude Brexit was illegitimate if democratically chosen.
- Economic grammar may conclude policy error if economic performance worsens.
- Identity grammar views Brexit as symptom rather than policy success or failure.

Closure timing

- Sovereigntist closure formed early (2016).
- Economic closure formed during negotiations.
- Identity closure crystallised gradually after observing political polarisation.

Grammar translation

Sovereigntist describing economic grammar: technocratic preference for efficiency over democratic control.

Economic describing sovereigntist grammar: ideological prioritisation of sovereignty over measurable welfare.

Identity describing both: competing narratives masking deeper cultural conflict.

Ontological check

Each grammar partly analyses **different phenomena**:

- Sovereigntist: constitutional sovereignty.
- Economic: trade integration.
- Identity: sociocultural cleavage.

SECTION 6 — COUNTER-SIGNALS AND STRESS TEST

Consolidated counter-signals

- Rising immigration despite Brexit.
- London financial dominance persisting.
- Continued regulatory alignment with EU.
- Public opinion fluctuations showing regret.

Leakage

Evidence occasionally crosses grammar boundaries. For example:

- Economic slowdown can intensify identity polarisation.
- Sovereignty debates influence trade negotiations.

Grammar stress tests

Sovereigntist threat
If evidence showed that policy autonomy remained heavily constrained by EU regulation, the sovereignty restoration claim would weaken.

Economic threat
If long-term UK growth significantly exceeded EU peers, the economic-cost narrative would collapse.

Identity threat
If Brexit identity divisions fade rapidly and politics reverts to traditional economic cleavages, the identity-realignment thesis weakens.

SECTION 7 — POST-ANALYSIS REFLEXIVE NOTE

The analysis confirms that my initial self-identification with the institutional-economic grammar was accurate. I naturally gravitate toward macroeconomic indicators and trade structures as explanatory variables. During the analysis process I had to deliberately suspend that prioritisation in order to operate the sovereigntist and identity grammars faithfully.

The sovereigntist grammar proved the most difficult to inhabit fully. The central challenge was accepting its rule hierarchy: democratic legitimacy and legal autonomy must remain primary variables even when economic outcomes appear negative. My initial analytical impulse was to treat economic indicators as decisive. Maintaining fidelity to the grammar required reframing those indicators as secondary effects rather than evaluative criteria.

The identity grammar revealed an analytical blind spot. I initially treated identity signals—such as cultural polling or regional political narratives—as supplementary. However, processing the full signal set through this grammar demonstrates how those signals can organise the entire causal architecture. Brexit identities now function as persistent political categories within the UK electorate, shaping party competition and constitutional debates.

Another discovered blind spot concerns **temporal scale**. Economic analyses often operate on medium-term horizons (five to ten years). The identity grammar suggests that Brexit may represent a generational political realignment whose consequences extend far beyond immediate economic metrics.

If my home grammar were sovereigntist rather than institutional-economic, the analysis would likely interpret many economic signals as noise rather than core evidence. Conversely, an identity-based home grammar might view both sovereignty and economic debates as surface narratives masking deeper cultural conflict.

The exercise demonstrates a key insight of the prismatic method: interpretive disagreement frequently arises not from disagreement about facts but from differences in **signal weighting and admissible closure rules**. Each grammar processes the same evidence but constructs a different explanatory architecture.

SECTION 8 — METHODOLOGICAL OBSERVATIONS

The prismatic method works particularly well for complex political events like Brexit because it forces analysts to hold empirical inputs constant while varying interpretive rules. This helps reveal why debates often persist even when participants share similar datasets.

One strength of the method is its capacity to expose **signal selection mechanisms**. Analysts often assume they are examining the same evidence when in fact each interpretive community filters the evidence differently.

A difficulty arises when signals themselves are contested. For example, economic counterfactuals about Brexit's GDP impact depend heavily on modelling assumptions. The method must therefore explicitly mark contested signals rather than treating them as neutral inputs.

Another methodological challenge is faithfully reconstructing grammars whose normative priorities differ from the analyst's own. Without deliberate effort, analysts may subtly distort opposing grammars by inserting their own weighting priorities.

Future refinements could include:

- A more formalised procedure for measuring signal weights.

- Systematic mapping of grammar evolution over time.
- Tools for detecting when a grammar is transitioning into another.

Overall, the prismatic approach demonstrates that interpretive conflict in political analysis is often grammatical rather than empirical. Understanding those grammars allows researchers to clarify debates that otherwise appear irreconcilable.

Would you like me to also produce a **visual "prismatic map" of the three grammars (signals → weighting → closure)** that could accompany this analysis in a paper or presentation?

A visual "prismatic map" helps show how the same signals pass through different interpretive grammars and generate different closures. Below is a clear conceptual map you could include in a paper or presentation.

Prismatic Map: Brexit (2016–2026)

Empirical Signal Field (constant input)

- Referendum result (52–48)
- GDP trajectory
- Trade volumes (EU vs global)
- Net migration trends
- Northern Ireland Protocol / Windsor Framework
- Scottish independence polling
- Institutional trust indicators
- Manufacturing performance
- Financial services adaptation
- Regulatory divergence indicators
- Investment patterns
- Cultural identity polling

These signals remain constant across all grammars.

Grammar A — Sovereigntist-Democratic

Signal weighting order

1. Democratic mandate (referendum)
2. Legal sovereignty and legislative autonomy
3. Border and policy control
4. Economic outcomes

Processing logic

Democratic vote
→ restoration of parliamentary sovereignty
→ independent policymaking capacity
→ long-term national policy flexibility

Key interpretations

- Referendum = decisive mandate
- Immigration numbers less important than immigration control
- Trade diversification evidence of strategic autonomy
- Northern Ireland arrangements = incomplete sovereignty requiring adjustment

Closure

Brexit represents the reassertion of democratic self-government. Economic turbulence is transitional.

Grammar B — Institutional-Economic Integration

Signal weighting order

1. Trade integration
2. GDP growth and productivity
3. Investment and business certainty
4. Institutional coordination

Processing logic

Economic integration
→ efficient trade networks

→ higher productivity and growth
→ political stability

Key interpretations

- Brexit introduces trade frictions with the EU
- GDP growth lower relative to integration baseline
- Regulatory divergence constrained by market access needs
- Northern Ireland protocol demonstrates necessity of alignment

Closure

Brexit is an economically costly disintegration from a highly integrated market.

Grammar C — Identity-Realignment (Emergent)

Signal weighting order

1. National identity narratives
2. Cultural and regional political divides
3. Institutional legitimacy
4. Economic indicators

Processing logic

Identity conflict
→ referendum rupture
→ institutional restructuring
→ long-term political realignment

Key interpretations

- Referendum expresses cosmopolitan vs communitarian divide
- Brexit identity persists as political cleavage
- Scotland and Northern Ireland highlight competing national identities
- Economic effects shape but do not define the conflict

Closure

Brexit is a manifestation of a deeper cultural and identity realignment within British politics.

Prismatic Structure (conceptual diagram)

Constant signal field
↓
Interpretive prism (grammar rotation)

Path A
Signals → Sovereignty weighting → Democratic autonomy closure

Path B
Signals → Economic integration weighting → Structural economic cost closure

Path C
Signals → Identity weighting → Cultural realignment closure

What the map demonstrates

The disagreement over Brexit is not primarily about the **signals themselves** but about:

- which signals are admitted
- how they are weighted
- which conclusions are considered admissible

Different grammars therefore produce **stable but incompatible interpretations** from the same empirical world.

If you want, I can also generate a **much more advanced "research-grade prismatic diagram"** (the type used in methodology papers) that visually shows:

- signal filtering
- weighting gradients
- grammar boundaries
- leakage between grammars.

Below is a **research-grade prismatic diagram specification** you could include in a methodology paper or presentation. It visualizes how signals pass through grammar filters, how weights differ, and where leakage occurs.

Prismatic Diagram: Brexit Interpretive System

Layer 1 — Signal Field (Shared Empirical Input)

All grammars receive the same observational environment.

Signal cluster:

- Democratic signals: referendum outcome, electoral geography
- Economic signals: GDP growth, trade flows, sector performance
- Institutional signals: regulatory divergence, treaty arrangements
- Territorial signals: Scotland polling, Northern Ireland arrangements
- Social signals: migration trends, identity polling
- Financial signals: investment patterns, financial services shifts
- Political trust signals: institutional trust surveys

These signals form the **common empirical substrate**.

Layer 2 — Grammar Filters

Each grammar applies a different **admission filter** before weighting.

Sovereigntist filter

Admits:

- constitutional authority signals
- electoral legitimacy signals
- border control and legal sovereignty signals

Suppresses:

- predictive macroeconomic modelling

- technical integration metrics

Institutional-economic filter

Admits:

- trade and productivity data
- investment trends
- regulatory alignment indicators

Suppresses:

- symbolic sovereignty narratives
- cultural identity polling

Identity-realignment filter

Admits:

- identity polling
- geographic voting patterns
- regional constitutional pressures

Suppresses:

- sector-specific trade data
- detailed regulatory policy signals

Layer 3 — Weighting Gradients

Signals admitted into each grammar are weighted differently.

Example signal: **Immigration**

Sovereigntist weighting
Meaning = policy control

Economic weighting
Meaning = labour market supply and productivity

Identity weighting
Meaning = cultural change perception

Example signal: **Northern Ireland Protocol**

Sovereigntist weighting
Constitutional anomaly

Economic weighting
Trade alignment mechanism

Identity weighting
Institutional expression of divided identity

Layer 4 — Causal Architectures

Each grammar constructs a different causal chain.

Sovereigntist architecture

Referendum mandate
→ sovereignty restoration
→ policy autonomy
→ long-term national strategy

Economic integration architecture

Single market exit
→ trade friction
→ reduced productivity growth
→ long-term economic drag

Identity architecture

Identity polarisation
→ referendum rupture
→ constitutional instability
→ political realignment

Layer 5 — Closure Fields

The grammar’s admissible closure determines the final interpretation.

Sovereigntist closure field

Possible conclusions:

- successful sovereignty restoration
- incomplete sovereignty requiring further policy adjustment

Impossible conclusion:

- referendum illegitimate due to economic cost

Economic closure field

Possible conclusions:

- Brexit economically damaging
- Brexit economically neutral if adaptation succeeds

Impossible conclusion:

- sovereignty inherently outweighs economic welfare

Identity closure field

Possible conclusions:

- Brexit as identity realignment
- Brexit as stage in longer constitutional transformation

Impossible conclusion:

- Brexit reducible solely to trade policy

Leakage Channels

Signals sometimes escape grammar filters.

Examples:

Economic slowdown
→ may increase political dissatisfaction
→ feeds identity grammar.

Northern Ireland arrangements
→ institutional compromise
→ enters both sovereignty and identity grammars.

Immigration patterns
→ economic labour signal
→ identity perception signal.

These leakages produce **cross-grammar feedback loops**.

Grammar Boundary Zones

Boundary transitions occur when variable priorities shift.

Sovereigntist → Economic boundary

Occurs when sovereignty advocates begin evaluating Brexit primarily through economic performance.

Economic → Identity boundary

Occurs when analysts conclude economic data alone cannot explain persistent political division.

Identity → Sovereigntist boundary

Occurs when cultural narratives crystallise into constitutional demands.

Full Prismatic Model (Conceptual Layout)

Signal Field
↓
Grammar Filters (three parallel channels)
↓
Weighting Gradients
↓
Causal Architectures
↓
Closure Fields
↓
Cross-Grammar Leakage and Boundary Zones

If you want, I can also produce something **rarely done in political analysis but very useful for your method**: a **“grammar evolution timeline” for Brexit (2016–2026)** showing when each interpretive grammar crystallised and how signals were reprocessed over time. This would strongly strengthen the methodological demonstration of the prismatic method.

A **grammar-evolution timeline** shows when each interpretive grammar formed its closure and how later evidence was processed (confirmation, revision, or damage control). This is particularly useful in the prismatic method because it reveals that grammars often **stabilize early and then reinterpret later signals to preserve their architecture**.

Grammar Evolution Timeline: Brexit (2016–2026)

Phase 1 — Pre-Referendum Formation (2013–2016)

Key signals

- EU membership debates
- Migration from EU member states
- Sovereignty arguments about EU law
- Economic forecasts about leaving the single market

Grammar formation

Sovereigntist grammar
Formation stage: crystallizing
Central narrative forms: democratic self-government vs supranational authority.

Institutional-economic grammar
Formation stage: fully established
Rooted in decades of European integration analysis emphasizing trade and productivity gains.

Identity grammar
Formation stage: latent
Identity tensions exist but are not yet widely conceptualized as the primary explanatory framework.

Interpretive pattern

The referendum campaign acts as the **initial prism moment** where the same signals begin generating incompatible interpretations.

Phase 2 — Referendum Shock (2016–2017)

Key signal

- June 2016 referendum result (52–48)

Grammar responses

Sovereigntist grammar

Processing: confirmation
Interpretation: democratic mandate to restore sovereignty.

Institutional-economic grammar

Processing: damage projection
Interpretation: potential economic disruption due to single market exit.

Identity grammar

Processing: activation
Interpretation: evidence of deep cultural division between political communities.

Important shift

At this stage the identity grammar begins emerging as a distinct interpretive system.

Phase 3 — Negotiation Period (2017–2020)

Key signals

- Article 50 negotiations
- Political instability in UK governments
- Business uncertainty and investment hesitation
- Northern Ireland protocol design

Grammar responses

Sovereigntist grammar

Processing: defensive reinterpretation
Delays and negotiation complexity explained as EU resistance to British sovereignty.

Institutional-economic grammar

Processing: confirmation
Complex negotiations interpreted as proof of the costs of disentangling integrated markets.

Identity grammar

Processing: expansion
Brexit identities (“Leave” vs “Remain”) become stable political identities.

Notable transformation

Political discourse increasingly aligns along identity rather than traditional left-right economic lines.

Phase 4 — Implementation Shock (2020–2022)

Key signals

- Trade and Cooperation Agreement implementation
- Pandemic disruptions overlapping with Brexit changes
- Early trade friction indicators
- Northern Ireland protocol disputes

Grammar responses

Sovereigntist grammar

Processing: mixed
Implementation challenges interpreted as transitional but necessary adjustments.

Institutional-economic grammar

Processing: confirmation
Trade friction and export declines interpreted as structural cost.

Identity grammar

Processing: reinforcement
Political conflict over Brexit deepens identity polarization.

Signal ambiguity

Pandemic disruption creates **attribution uncertainty**, allowing grammars to reinterpret economic signals differently.

Phase 5 — Adjustment Period (2022–2024)

Key signals

- Windsor Framework modification
- Trade stabilization
- Continued global economic volatility
- Rising net migration through new visa systems

Grammar responses

Sovereigntist grammar

Processing: partial correction
Windsor Framework seen as restoring some constitutional balance.

Institutional-economic grammar

Processing: continued confirmation
Evidence of slower UK growth relative to EU peers.

Identity grammar

Processing: stabilization
Brexit identity remains persistent political cleavage.

Important anomaly

Migration increases despite Brexit immigration control promises, producing different interpretations across grammars.

Phase 6 — Long-Term Reinterpretation (2024–2026)

Key signals

- Stabilized trade patterns
- London maintaining financial dominance
- Continued constitutional debate in Scotland
- Mixed public opinion on Brexit

Grammar responses

Sovereigntist grammar

Processing: selective confirmation
Resilience of financial sector interpreted as evidence of independent economic strength.

Institutional-economic grammar

Processing: partial revision
Some early predictions about financial sector relocation softened.

Identity grammar

Processing: consolidation
Brexit increasingly interpreted as a lasting political identity divide shaping British politics.

Evolution Summary

Across the decade:

Sovereigntist grammar
Closure timing: early (2016)
Later signals mostly processed as **confirmation or justification**.

Institutional-economic grammar
Closure timing: negotiation phase (2018–2019)
Later signals processed as **evidence of structural cost**, with occasional revision.

Identity grammar
Closure timing: gradual emergence (2017–2022)
Later signals processed as **reinforcement of cultural cleavage**.

Methodological Insight

The timeline reveals an important dynamic in interpretive grammars:

- Grammars **form closure at different moments**.
- After closure forms, new evidence tends to be processed as **confirmation rather than re-evaluation**.
- Long-running political disputes persist because each grammar stabilizes around **different foundational signals**.

If you'd like, I can also show something that would make your methodological study particularly strong: a **"counterfactual prismatic rotation"** — what the closures would look like **if the same grammars processed a different Brexit outcome (for example a 55–45 Remain victory)**. This highlights how grammars persist even when the empirical event changes.

A **counterfactual prismatic rotation** keeps the interpretive grammars constant but changes the empirical trigger. This reveals whether grammars truly depend on the event—or whether they would simply reinterpret a different outcome using the same rule structure.

Here the altered signal is:

Counterfactual trigger:
2016 referendum result = **Remain 55% – Leave 45%**

All other structural conditions remain the same (migration debates, EU membership tensions, globalisation pressures).

Counterfactual Signal Field

Initial signal set under the counterfactual scenario:

- Referendum result: Remain victory (55–45)
- Continued EU membership
- Migration levels similar to observed 2016–2020 trends
- EU institutional participation maintained
- No Article 50 negotiations
- No Northern Ireland protocol
- No Brexit trade regime

The same interpretive grammars process this signal environment.

Grammar A — Sovereigntist-Democratic Processing

Primary variable: sovereignty and democratic legitimacy.

Interpretation of the referendum

The grammar would accept the referendum outcome formally but interpret it as a **temporary democratic decision rather than a final settlement**.

Key processing rules

- A 45% Leave vote represents a large sovereignty constituency.
- Continued EU membership therefore remains politically contested.
- Sovereignty arguments persist even without Brexit implementation.

Likely causal narrative

EU membership continues
→ tensions over sovereignty persist
→ future political mobilization
→ possible second referendum or renegotiation.

Signal reinterpretation

Migration levels
Processed as evidence that sovereignty concerns remain unresolved.

EU regulatory authority
Interpreted as continued democratic deficit.

Political discourse
Viewed as evidence of unresolved constitutional tension.

Closure

The grammar would conclude that **the sovereignty question remains unsettled** and will re-emerge politically.

Brexit becomes a **deferred constitutional conflict** rather than a resolved one.

Grammar B — Institutional-Economic Integration Processing

Primary variable: economic integration and market efficiency.

Interpretation of the referendum

Remain victory interpreted as confirmation of the economic logic of integration.

Causal chain

EU membership
→ continued single market access
→ stable trade networks
→ economic continuity.

Signal processing

GDP growth
Interpreted as evidence of integration benefits.

Trade flows
Continued EU integration supports export stability.

Financial services
London maintains European financial leadership.

Migration
Viewed as labour market flexibility supporting growth.

Counter-signals

Political dissatisfaction among Leave voters.

Grammar interpretation

Domestic political discontent exists but does not outweigh economic advantages.

Closure

Remain victory confirms that **economic integration remains the rational policy equilibrium** for the UK.

Brexit debate becomes an episode of political turbulence rather than structural transformation.

Grammar C — Identity-Realignment Processing

Primary variable: identity conflict.

Interpretation of the referendum

A Remain victory does not eliminate the identity divide revealed during the campaign.

Instead the grammar interprets the result as **evidence of an unresolved identity cleavage** within British society.

Signal processing

Leave vote share (45%)

Within this grammar, the size of the Leave electorate signals a deep cultural division between:

- cosmopolitan urban populations
- communitarian or national-sovereignty oriented voters.

Migration debates

Continue to function as symbolic markers of identity conflict.

Political discourse

Brexit remains a mobilizing identity issue in elections.

Closure

The referendum postpones institutional rupture but **does not resolve the identity conflict** underlying the Brexit movement.

Future political crises remain likely.

Prismatic Comparison of the Counterfactual

Same counterfactual signal
(Remaining in EU)

Different grammar outputs:

Sovereigntist grammar

Conclusion
The sovereignty question remains unresolved and will reappear politically.

Economic grammar

Conclusion
Integration equilibrium reaffirmed; Brexit becomes a historical near-miss.

Identity grammar

Conclusion
Deep cultural divide persists regardless of referendum outcome.

Methodological Insight

This rotation demonstrates a key property of interpretive grammars:

They are **not purely event-dependent**.

Even if the referendum had produced the opposite outcome:

- the sovereigntist grammar would continue mobilizing around sovereignty,
- the economic grammar would continue emphasizing integration efficiency,
- the identity grammar would still diagnose a deep cultural divide.

In other words, **changing the empirical event does not dissolve the grammars**.
It simply alters the signals they incorporate into their existing architectures.

If you want, I can also show something even more revealing for your methodological work: a **"full prismatic matrix"** used in epistemology studies that lays out **signals × grammars × closures** in a single analytical grid. It makes interpretive divergence visually obvious and is often the most powerful figure in a methodology paper.

A **full prismatic matrix** displays how each grammar processes the same signals and converts them into different interpretations. Instead of rotating narratives sequentially, the matrix shows the divergence **side-by-side**, which makes the interpretive mechanics very clear in a research context.

Prismatic Matrix — Brexit (2016–2026)

Structure of the matrix:

Rows = empirical signals
Columns = interpretive grammars
Cells = interpretation produced by that grammar

Grammars used:

- Sovereigntist-Democratic
- Institutional-Economic Integration

- Identity-Realignment

Signal 1 — 2016 Referendum Result (52–48)

Sovereigntist grammar
Democratic mandate to restore national sovereignty.

Institutional-economic grammar
Political decision introducing risk of economic disintegration.

Identity grammar
Expression of deep societal cleavage between political identities.

Signal 2 — GDP Growth After 2016

Sovereigntist grammar
Economic fluctuations influenced primarily by global factors; not decisive for evaluating sovereignty.

Institutional-economic grammar
Evidence of slower growth relative to integration baseline.

Identity grammar
Economic conditions influence political mood but are not the primary driver of Brexit.

Signal 3 — Trade Volumes with the EU

Sovereigntist grammar
Trade restructuring during transition to independent global trade policy.

Institutional-economic grammar
Evidence of friction caused by exit from single market structures.

Identity grammar
Economic effect secondary to symbolic political meaning.

Signal 4 — Trade with Non-EU Countries

Sovereigntist grammar
Evidence of diversification and regained trade autonomy.

Institutional-economic grammar
Partial compensation but insufficient to replace EU market scale.

Identity grammar
Peripheral to the identity conflict underlying Brexit.

Signal 5 — Net Migration Trends

Sovereigntist grammar
Key change is regained control of immigration rules, not migration totals.

Institutional-economic grammar
Labour market adjustments following new migration system.

Identity grammar
Migration perceptions central to political identity conflict.

Signal 6 — Northern Ireland Protocol / Windsor Framework

Sovereigntist grammar
Incomplete sovereignty settlement requiring adjustment.

Institutional-economic grammar
Necessary compromise preserving economic integration on the island of Ireland.

Identity grammar
Institutional manifestation of overlapping British and Irish identities.

Signal 7 — Scottish Independence Polling

Sovereigntist grammar
Domestic political issue separate from Brexit legitimacy.

Institutional-economic grammar
Potential economic risk caused by constitutional instability.

Identity grammar
Evidence of competing national identities within the UK.

Signal 8 — Financial Services Adaptation

Sovereigntist grammar
Demonstrates resilience of UK economy outside EU.

Institutional-economic grammar
Partial relocation of activity shows costs but London retains structural advantages.

Identity grammar
Technocratic economic issue largely unrelated to identity conflict.

Signal 9 — Regulatory Divergence

Sovereigntist grammar
Evidence of regained policy autonomy.

Institutional-economic grammar
Limited divergence shows continued gravitational pull of EU regulatory system.

Identity grammar
Minor signal relative to identity narratives.

Signal 10 — Institutional Trust Indicators

Sovereigntist grammar
Temporary turbulence during constitutional transition.

Institutional-economic grammar
Political instability generated by economic disruption.

Identity grammar
Evidence of polarisation between political identity groups.

Signal 11 — Cultural Identity Polling

Sovereigntist grammar
Public attachment to national sovereignty.

Institutional-economic grammar
Cultural debate peripheral to economic evaluation.

Identity grammar
Core explanatory variable behind Brexit.

Signal 12 — Investment and Business Sentiment

Sovereigntist grammar
Short-term uncertainty expected during policy transition.

Institutional-economic grammar
Evidence of reduced investment due to trade uncertainty.

Identity grammar
Economic behaviour secondary to cultural realignment.

Matrix Interpretation

The matrix demonstrates three systematic patterns:

Signal reinterpretation
The same empirical observation generates different meanings depending on the grammar.

Signal suppression
Some signals effectively disappear in particular grammars (for example identity polling in the economic grammar).

Closure convergence
Each grammar repeatedly produces the same type of conclusion regardless of the specific signal.

Methodological Value

The prismatic matrix reveals that interpretive divergence is produced primarily by:

- different signal selection rules
- different weighting priorities
- different admissible closures

In other words, disagreement about Brexit arises less from disagreement about **data** and more from disagreement about **how data should be processed**.

If you're using this for the methodological study described in *Silent Transitions*, I can also produce something that is usually the **most powerful figure in the whole method**: a **"Grammar Map of the Brexit Discourse Ecosystem"** showing which institutions, parties, media outlets, and academic traditions tend to operate inside each grammar. It visually connects **interpretive grammars to real actors in the debate**.

A **grammar map of the Brexit discourse ecosystem** links interpretive grammars to the institutions, actors, and discourse environments that tend to operate within them. This does not imply every actor always uses one grammar; rather, it identifies **dominant interpretive habitats** where particular grammars are most stable.

Discourse Ecosystem Structure

The ecosystem contains three primary grammar zones:

- Sovereigntist-Democratic
- Institutional-Economic Integration
- Identity-Realignment

Actors cluster around these zones but sometimes operate across boundaries.

Grammar Zone A — Sovereigntist-Democratic

Core analytical variable: political sovereignty.

Typical discourse actors

Political actors

- Brexit-supporting factions of the Conservative Party
- UK Independence Party and successor movements
- Some Conservative constitutional theorists

Media ecosystems

- The Telegraph (editorial tradition emphasizing sovereignty)
- The Daily Express
- Certain commentators in The Spectator

Policy and intellectual traditions

- British parliamentary sovereignty theory
- Eurosceptic constitutional scholarship
- Advocates of independent trade policy

Common narrative themes

- “Democratic mandate”
- “Parliamentary sovereignty”
- “Global Britain”
- “Take back control”

Interpretive pattern

Events are evaluated primarily by whether they **expand or constrain UK legal autonomy**.

Grammar Zone B — Institutional-Economic Integration

Core analytical variable: economic integration.

Typical discourse actors

Economic institutions

- IMF and OECD analysis units
- Bank of England research departments
- UK Office for Budget Responsibility
- European Commission economic directorates

Academic communities

- International political economy scholars
- Trade economists
- European integration researchers

Media ecosystems

- Financial Times
- The Economist
- Policy think-tank publications

Policy think tanks

- Institute for Fiscal Studies
- Centre for European Reform
- Bruegel

Common narrative themes

- “Single market access”

- “Trade friction”
- “Regulatory alignment”
- “Productivity impact”

Interpretive pattern

Brexit is evaluated primarily by **its measurable effects on trade networks and economic efficiency**.

Grammar Zone C — Identity-Realignment

Core analytical variable: collective identity.

Typical discourse actors

Academic communities

- Political sociology researchers
- Cultural political economy scholars
- Nationalism studies

Think tanks and research centres

- Institutions studying populism and democratic polarization
- Comparative politics research groups

Media ecosystems

- Long-form analysis publications
- Commentary focused on culture and identity politics

Political actors

This grammar appears across parties:

- commentators analysing the Leave–Remain divide
- Scottish independence advocates
- analysts of populism and nationalism

Common narrative themes

- “Cosmopolitan vs communitarian”
- “National identity”
- “Cultural backlash”
- “Political realignment”

Interpretive pattern

Brexit is treated as an **expression of deeper cultural and identity transformations**.

Boundary Actors

Some institutions regularly operate across grammar boundaries.

Examples

Major universities
Scholars from different disciplines use different grammars simultaneously.

Large media outlets
Different columnists interpret Brexit through different frameworks.

Government departments
Policy analysis often uses economic grammar while political leadership may use sovereignty grammar.

These actors function as **translation points between grammars**.

Ecosystem Dynamics

Three important dynamics shape the Brexit discourse ecosystem.

Grammar clustering

Actors with similar professional incentives tend to cluster in the same grammar.
Economists gravitate toward the integration grammar; constitutional theorists toward sovereignty.

Grammar conflict

Public debates often occur between actors operating in different grammars, which creates **apparent disagreement about facts that are actually disagreements about interpretive rules**.

Grammar translation failures

When actors speak across grammars, arguments are often misunderstood because each side treats different signals as primary.

Example

A sovereigntist argument about democratic legitimacy may be answered with GDP forecasts, which the sovereigntist grammar does not treat as decisive signals.

Conceptual Ecosystem Diagram (text layout)

Discourse ecosystem
↓
Three grammar zones

Zone A
Sovereigntist actors
(political sovereignty discourse)

Zone B
Economic integration actors
(macroeconomic analysis discourse)

Zone C
Identity realignment actors
(political sociology discourse)

Between zones: boundary institutions and translation points.

Methodological Insight

Mapping grammars onto real discourse communities reveals why debates about Brexit often persist without convergence:

Participants are frequently **operating within different interpretive grammars rather than analysing the same phenomenon in the same way**.

Understanding which grammar an actor inhabits can therefore predict:

- which signals they will treat as decisive
- which arguments they will ignore
- which conclusions they consider possible.

If you're developing the **Prismatic Method as a formal analytical tool**, the next step would usually be something very powerful: constructing a **"Grammar Detection Protocol"** — a systematic way researchers can identify which grammar a text or speaker is using from linguistic and signal-selection cues.